

Ian Cowpar

Senior PM | 0→1 self-serve flows in compliance domains | AI-as-co-builder | ships working prototypes, not specs

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SUMMARY

Senior PM with a track record of building 0→1 self-serve products inside compliance-heavy enterprise environments. I take ideas from discovery through working prototype through engineering handoff — and I write the working prototype myself in Claude Code rather than handing engineering a spec and waiting. Two years at UKG (Senior PM, \$250M ARR) building self-serve flows that absorbed enterprise complexity behind the scenes; ten years before that at Broadridge running compliance-grade financial services deployments. The discipline transfers cleanly to SMB: the harder version of the problem is enterprise complexity, and the design instinct I built there scales down faster than the typical SMB PM scales up.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR | 0→1 self-serve products, AI-fluent prototyping, compliance-heavy enterprise

- **Built a 0→1 self-serve migration product, idea to production.** Took it from concept through three business-epic decomposition (UI, rules, deployment), built the working prototype myself in Claude Code, designed the UX feedback loop and persona, and handed engineering a complete package — bepics, epics, stories, Gantt, roadmap. Now in active production; the Services org runs migrations independently without an engineering ticket. Closes the gap between licensing the platform and actually using it.
- **Built UKG product's first organized AI capability layer.** Started as personal tooling, scaled into team-wide shared capability without a top-down mandate. Adoption spread because the thing worked better than what it replaced — the only kind of adoption that lasts. Receipt for AI-as-co-builder posture, not a claim.
- **Designed a five-panel operational analytics product** classifying open issues across customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise across four products; auto-refreshed daily, with a Claude Code function I built into the tool surfacing the single highest-leverage action per panel. Opinionated routing, not a dashboard.
- **Designed sprint health instrumentation** refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns. Opinionated tooling with a thesis baked into what it measured.
- **Served as the product-side voice on enterprise customer escalation and pre-upgrade calls** — synthesizing what customers actually needed versus what was on the roadmap. Discovery muscle in its hardest configuration.

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade financial services environment; developed strong instincts for regulatory consequence, requirements quality, and the difference between a delivery that closes and a product that keeps producing.
- Internal SME for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full client base; translated complex compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

Product: 0→1 product building, self-serve flow design, customer discovery, persona and UX feedback loops, MVP definition, end-to-end delivery from prototype to production

AI as Co-Builder: Claude Code prototyping, agentic workflows, AI-fluent product development, PM automation, zero-translation building

Compliance & Enterprise: Regulatory-consequence delivery, compliance-grade financial services, multi-stakeholder coordination, executive customer engagement

Data: Operational analytics products, opinionated instrumentation, KPI definition, qualitative-to-structured synthesis

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on AI adoption, unofficial leadership, and team dynamics. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement.